Rna rnalen basecount definitions

Recall the definitions: The set of RNA strands S is defined (recursively) by:

Basis Step:	$\mathtt{A} \in S, \mathtt{C} \in S, \mathtt{U} \in S, \mathtt{G} \in S$
Recursive Step:	If $s \in S$ and $b \in B$, then $sb \in S$

where sb is string concatenation.

The function *rnalen* that computes the length of RNA strands in S is defined recursively by:

		$rnalen : S$	$\to \mathbb{Z}^+$
Basis Step:	If $b \in B$ then	$rnalen(b)$	$= 1$
Recursive Step:	If $s \in S$ and $b \in B$, then	$rnalen(sb)$	$= 1 + rnalen(s)$

The function *basecount* that computes the number of a given base b appearing in a RNA strand s is defined recursively by:

		$basecount : S \times B$	$\to \mathbb{N}$	
Basis Step:	If $b_1 \in B, b_2 \in B$	$basecount(\ (b_1, b_2)\ )$	$= \begin{cases} 1 & \text{when } b_1 = b_2 \\ 0 & \text{when } b_1 \neq b_2 \end{cases}$	
Recursive Step:	If $s \in S, b_1 \in B, b_2 \in B$	$basecount(\ (sb_1, b_2)\ )$	$= \begin{cases} 1 + basecount(\ (s, b_2)\ ) & \text{when } b_1 = b_2 \\ basecount(\ (s, b_2)\ ) & \text{when } b_1 \neq b_2 \end{cases}$	

Alternating quantifiers order rna examples

Alternating nested quantifiers

$$\forall s \in S\ \exists n \in \mathbb{N}\ (\ basecount(\ (s, \mathtt{U})\ ) = n\ )$$

In English: For each strand, there is a nonnnegative integer that counts the number of occurrences of `U` in that strand.

$$\exists n \in \mathbb{N}\ \forall s \in S\ (\ basecount(\ (s, \mathtt{U})\ ) = n\ )$$

In English: There is a nonnnegative integer that counts the number of occurrences of `U` in every strand.

Are these statements true or false?

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (1)

$$\forall s \in S \; \exists b \in B \; (\; basecount(\; (s, b) \;) = 3 \;)$$

In English: For each RNA strand there is a base that occurs 3 times in this strand.

Write the negation and use De Morgan's law to find a logically equivalent version where the negation is applied only to the BC predicate (not next to a quantifier).

Is the original statement **True** or **False**?

Quiz translating counting quantifiers

Suppose $P(x)$ is a predicate over a domain D.

1. To translate the statement "There are at least two elements in D where the predicate P evaluates to true", we could write

   $$\exists x_1 \in D \, \exists x_2 \in D \, (P(x_1) \wedge P(x_2) \wedge _____)$$

2. To translate the statement "There are at most two elements in D where the predicate P evaluates to true", we could write

   $$\forall x_1 \in D \, \forall x_2 \in D \, \forall x_3 \in D \; (\; (\; P(x_1) \wedge P(x_2) \wedge P(x_3) \;) \rightarrow (\; x_1 = x_2 \vee x_2 = x_3 \vee x_1 = x_3 \;) \;)$$

   Why?

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (2)

Proof strategies quantification finite domain

When a predicate $P(x)$ is over a **finite** domain:

- To show that $\forall x P(x)$ is true: check that $P(x)$ evaluates to T at each domain element by evaluating over and over. This is called "Proof of universal by **exhaustion**".
- To show that $\forall x P(x)$ is false: find a **counterexample**, a domain element where $P(x)$ evaluates to F.
- To show that $\exists x P(x)$ is true: find a **witness**, a domain element where $P(x)$ evaluates to T.
- To show that $\exists x P(x)$ is false: check that $P(x)$ evaluates to F at each domain element by evaluating over and over. DeMorgan's Law gives that $\neg\exists x P(x) \quad \equiv \quad \forall x \neg P(x)$ so this amounts to a proof of universal by exhaustion.

Proof strategy universal generalization

New! Proof by universal generalization: To prove that $\forall x\, P(x)$ is true, we can take an arbitrary element e from the domain of quantification and show that $P(e)$ is true, without making any assumptions about e other than that it comes from the domain.
An **arbitrary** element of a set or domain is a fixed but unknown element from that set.

Proof strategies conditionals

New! Proof of conditional by direct proof: To prove that the conditional statement $p \to q$ is true, we can assume p is true and use that assumption to show q is true.

New! Proof of conditional by contrapositive proof: To prove that the implication $p \to q$ is true, we can assume q is false and use that assumption to show p is also false.

New! Proof of disjuction using equivalent conditional: To prove that the disjunction $p \vee q$ is true, we can rewrite it equivalently as $\neg p \to q$ and then use direct proof or contrapositive proof.

Proof strategies proof by cases

New! Proof by Cases: To prove q, we can work by cases by first describing all possible cases we might be in and then showing that each one guarantees q. Formally, if we know that $p_1 \vee p_2$ is true, and we can show that $(p_1 \to q)$ is true and we can show that $(p_2 \to q)$, then we can conclude q is true.

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (3)

Proof strategies ands

New! Proof of conjunctions with subgoals: To show that $p \wedge q$ is true, we have two subgoals: subgoal (1) prove p is true; and, subgoal (2) prove q is true.

To show that $p \wedge q$ is false, it's enough to prove that $\neg p$.
To show that $p \wedge q$ is false, it's enough to prove that $\neg q$.

Sets proof strategies

To prove that one set is a subset of another, e.g. to show $A \subseteq B$:

To prove that two sets are equal, e.g. to show $A = B$:

Sets equality example

Example: $\{43, 7, 9\} = \{7, 43, 9, 7\}$

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (4)

Sets basic proofs

Prove or **disprove**: $\{\texttt{A}, \texttt{C}, \texttt{U}, \texttt{G}\} \subseteq \{\texttt{AA}, \texttt{AC}, \texttt{AU}, \texttt{AG}\}$

Prove or **disprove**: For some set Y, $\emptyset \in Y$.

Prove or **disprove**: For every set Y, $\emptyset \in you$.

Prove or **disprove**: The empty set is a subset of every set.

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (5)

Prove or **disprove**: The empty set is a proper subset of every set.

Prove or **disprove**: $\{4, 6\} \subseteq \{n \mid \exists c \in \mathbb{Z}(n = 4c)\}$

Prove or **disprove**: $\{4, 6\} \subseteq \{n \bmod 10 \mid \exists c \in \mathbb{Z}(n = 4c)\}$

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (6)

Proofs signposting

Consider . . . , an **arbitrary** . . . . **Assume** . . . , we **want to show** that . . . . Which is what was needed, so the proof is complete □.

or, in other words:

Let . . . be an **arbitrary** . . . . **Assume** . . . , **WTS** that . . . **QED**.

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (7)

Set operations union intersection powerset

Cartesian product: When A and B are sets,

$$A \times B = \{(a, b) \mid a \in A \wedge b \in B\}$$

Example: $\{43, 9\} \times \{9, \mathbb{Z}\} =$

Example: $\mathbb{Z} \times \emptyset =$

Union: When A and B are sets,

$$A \cup B = \{x \mid x \in A \vee x \in B\}$$

Example: $\{43, 9\} \cup \{9, \mathbb{Z}\} =$

Example: $\mathbb{Z} \cup \emptyset =$

Intersection: When A and B are sets,

$$A \cap B = \{x \mid x \in A \wedge x \in B\}$$

Example: $\{43, 9\} \cap \{9, \mathbb{Z}\} =$

Example: $\mathbb{Z} \cap \emptyset =$

Set difference: When A and B are sets,

$$A - B = \{x \mid x \in A \wedge x \notin B\}$$

Example: $\{43, 9\} - \{9, \mathbb{Z}\} =$

Example: $\mathbb{Z} - \emptyset =$

Disjoint sets: sets A and B are disjoint means $A \cap B = \emptyset$

Example: $\{43, 9\}, \{9, \mathbb{Z}\}$ are not disjoint

Example: The sets $\mathbb{Z}$ and $\emptyset$ are disjoint

Power set: When U is a set, $\mathcal{P}(U) = \{X \mid X \subseteq U\}$

Example: $\mathcal{P}(\{43, 9\}) =$

Example: $\mathcal{P}(\emptyset) =$

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (8)

Sets basic proofs operations

Let $W = \mathcal{P}(\{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\})$

Example elements in W are:

Prove or **disprove**: $\forall A \in W \, \forall B \in W \; (A \subseteq B \; \rightarrow \; \mathcal{P}(A) \subseteq \mathcal{P}(B))$

Prove or **disprove**: $\forall A \in W \, \forall B \in W \; (\mathcal{P}(A) = \mathcal{P}(B) \; \rightarrow \; A = B)$

Prove or **disprove**: $\forall A \in W \, \forall B \in W \, \forall C \in W \; (A \cup B = A \cup C \; \rightarrow \; B = C)$

Proof strategies road map

We now have propositional and predicate logic that can help us express statements about any domain. We will develop proof strategies to craft valid argument for proving that such statements are true or disproving them (by showing they are false). We will practice these strategies with statements about sets and numbers, both because they are familiar and because they can be used to build cryptographic systems. Then we will apply proof strategies more broadly to prove statements about data structures and machine learning applications.

Numbers facts

1. Addition and multiplication of real numbers are each commutative and associative.

2. The product of two positive numbers is positive, of two negative numbers is positive, and of a positive and a negative number is negative.

3. The sum of two integers, the product of two integers, and the difference between two integers are each integers.

4. For every integer x there is no integer strictly between x and $x + 1$,

5. When x, y are positive integers, $xy \geq x$ and $xy \geq y$.

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (9)

Factoring definition

Definition: When a and b are integers and a is nonzero, a **divides** b means there is an integer c such that $b = ac$.

Symbolically, $F(\ (a, b)\ ) =$ and is a predicate over the domain _____

Other (synonymous) ways to say that $F(\ (a, b)\ )$ is true:

a is a **factor** of b a is a **divisor** of b b is a **multiple** of a $a|b$

When a is a positive integer and b is any integer, $a|b$ exactly when b **mod** $a = 0$

When a is a positive integer and b is any integer, $a|b$ exactly when $b = a \cdot (b$ **div** $a)$

Factoring translation examples

Translate these quantified statements by matching to English statement on right.

$\exists a \in \mathbb{Z}^{\neq 0}\ (\ F(\ (a, a)\ )\ )$	Every nonzero integer is a factor of itself.
$\exists a \in \mathbb{Z}^{\neq 0}\ (\ \neg F(\ (a, a)\ )\ )$	No nonzero integer is a factor of itself.
$\forall a \in \mathbb{Z}^{\neq 0}\ (\ F(\ (a, a)\ )\ )$	At least one nonzero integer is a factor of itself.
$\forall a \in \mathbb{Z}^{\neq 0}\ (\ \neg F(\ (a, a)\ )\ )$	Some nonzero integer is not a factor of itself.

Factoring basic claims

Claim: Every nonzero integer is a factor of itself.

Proof:

Prove or **Disprove**: There is a nonzero integer that does not divide its square.

Prove or **Disprove**: Every positive factor of a positive integer is less than or equal to it.

Factoring basic claims continued

Claim: Every nonzero integer is a factor of itself and every nonzero integer divides its square.

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (10)

Factoring even odd

Definition: an integer n is **even** means that there is an integer a such that $n = 2a$; an integer n is **odd** means that there is an integer a such that $n = 2a + 1$. Equivalently, an integer n is **even** means $n \mod 2 = 0$; an integer n is **odd** means $n \mod 2 = 1$. Also, an integer is even if and only if it is not odd.

Prime number definition

Definition: An integer p greater than 1 is called **prime** means the only positive factors of p are 1 and p. A positive integer that is greater than 1 and is not prime is called composite.

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (11)

Primes basic claims

Extra examples: Use the definition to prove that 1 is not prime, 2 is prime, 3 is prime, 4 is not prime, 5 is prime, 6 is not prime, and 7 is prime.

True or False: The statement "There are three consecutive positive integers that are prime."

Hint: These numbers would be of the form $p, p+1, p+2$ (where p is a positive integer).

Proof: We need to show _____

True or False: The statement "There are three consecutive odd positive integers that are prime."

Hint: These numbers would be of the form $p, p+2, p+4$ (where p is an odd positive integer).

Proof: We need to show _____

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (12)

Quantification definition

The **universal quantification** of predicate $P(x)$ over domain U is the statement "$P(x)$ for all values of x in the domain U" and is written $\forall x P(x)$ or $\forall x \in U\ P(x)$. When the domain is finite, universal quantification over the domain is equivalent to iterated *conjunction* (ands).

The **existential quantification** of predicate $P(x)$ over domain U is the statement "There exists an element x in the domain U such that $P(x)$" and is written $\exists x P(x)$ for $\exists x \in U\ P(x)$. When the domain is finite, existential quantification over the domain is equivalent to iterated *disjunction* (ors).

Quantification logical equivalence

Statements involving predicates and quantifiers are **logically equivalent** means they have the same truth value no matter which predicates (domains and functions) are substituted in.

Quantifier version of De Morgan's laws: $\boxed{\neg\forall x P(x) \ \equiv\ \exists x\,(\neg P(x))}$ $\boxed{\neg\exists x Q(x) \ \equiv\ \forall x\,(\neg Q(x))}$

Quantification witness counterexample

An element for which $P(x) = F$ is called a **counterexample** of $\forall x P(x)$. When there is a counterexample in the domain of predicate P, $\forall x P(x)$ is false.

An element for which $P(x) = T$ is called a **witness** of $\exists x P(x)$. When there is a witness in the domain of predicate P, then $\exists x P(x)$ is true.

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (13)

Quantification examples finite domain

Examples of quantifications using $V(x), N(x), Mystery(x)$:

True or **False**: $\exists x\ (\ V(x) \vee N(x)\ )$

True or **False**: $\forall x\ (\ V(x) \vee N(x)\ )$

True or **False**: $\exists x\ (\ \neg V(x) \wedge \neg N(x)\ )$

True or **False**: $\forall x\ (\ V(x) \rightarrow N(x)\ )$

True or **False**: $\exists x\ (\ N(x) \leftrightarrow Mystery(x)\ )$

Rewrite $\neg\forall x\ (\ V(x) \oplus Mystery(x)\ )$ into a logically equivalent statement.

Notice that these are examples where the predicates have *finite* domain. How would we evaluate quantifications where the domain may be infinite?

Rna rnalen basecount definitions

Recall the definitions: The set of RNA strands S is defined (recursively) by:

Basis Step:	$\mathtt{A} \in S, \mathtt{C} \in S, \mathtt{U} \in S, \mathtt{G} \in S$
Recursive Step:	If $s \in S$ and $b \in B$, then $sb \in S$

where sb is string concatenation.

The function *rnalen* that computes the length of RNA strands in S is defined recursively by:

		$rnalen : S$	$\rightarrow \mathbb{Z}^+$
Basis Step:	If $b \in B$ then	$rnalen(b)$	$= 1$
Recursive Step:	If $s \in S$ and $b \in B$, then	$rnalen(sb)$	$= 1 + rnalen(s)$

The function *basecount* that computes the number of a given base b appearing in a RNA strand s is defined recursively by:

		$basecount : S \times B$	$\rightarrow \mathbb{N}$	
Basis Step:	If $b_1 \in B, b_2 \in B$	$basecount(\ (b_1, b_2)\ )$	$= \begin{cases} 1 & \text{when } b_1 = b_2 \\ 0 & \text{when } b_1 \neq b_2 \end{cases}$	
Recursive Step:	If $s \in S, b_1 \in B, b_2 \in B$	$basecount(\ (sb_1, b_2)\ )$	$= \begin{cases} 1 + basecount(\ (s, b_2)\ ) & \text{when } b_1 = b_2 \\ basecount(\ (s, b_2)\ ) & \text{when } b_1 \neq b_2 \end{cases}$	

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (14)

Predicates example rnalen basecount

L with domain $S \times \mathbb{Z}^+$ is defined by, for $s \in S$ and $n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$,

$$L(\ (s,n)\ ) = \begin{cases} T & \text{if } rnalen(s) = n \\ F & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

In other words, $L(\ (s,n)\ )$ means $rnalen(s) = n$

BC with domain $S \times B \times \mathbb{N}$ is defined by, for $s \in S$ and $b \in B$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$BC(\ (s,b,n)\ ) = \begin{cases} T & \text{if } basecount(\ (s,b)\ ) = n \\ F & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

In other words, $BC(\ (s,b,n)\ )$ means $basecount(\ (s,b)\ ) = n$

Example where L evaluates to T: _____ Why?

Example where BC evaluates to T: _____ Why?

Example where L evaluates to F: _____ Why?

Example where BC evaluates to F: _____ Why?

$$\exists t\ BC(t) \qquad \exists (s,b,n) \in S \times B \times \mathbb{N}\ (basecount(\ (s,b)\ ) = n)$$

In English:

Witness that proves this existential quantification is true:

$$\forall t\ BC(t) \qquad \forall (s,b,n) \in S \times B \times \mathbb{N}\ (basecount(\ (s,b)\ ) = n)$$

In English:

Counterexample that proves this universal quantification is false:

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (15)

Predicates projecting example rna basecount

New predicates from old: Consider several different predicates that are related to BC:

1. Define the **new** predicate with domain $S \times B$ and rule

   $$basecount(\ (s, b)\ ) = 3$$

   Example domain element where predicate is T:

2. Define the **new** predicate with domain $S \times \mathbb{N}$ and rule

   $$basecount(\ (s, \mathtt{A})\ ) = n$$

   Example domain element where predicate is T:

3. Define the **new** predicate with domain $S \times B$ and rule

   $$\exists n \in \mathbb{N}\ (basecount(\ (s, b)\ ) = n)$$

   Example domain element where predicate is T:

4. Define the **new** predicate with domain S and rule

   $$\forall b \in B\ (basecount(\ (s, b)\ ) = 1)$$

   Example domain element where predicate is T:

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (16)

Nested quantifiers

Nested quantifiers

$$\forall s \in S\ \forall b \in B\ \forall n \in \mathbb{N}\ (basecount(\ (s, b)\ ) = n)$$

In English:

Counterexample that proves this universal quantification is false:

$$\forall n \in \mathbb{N}\ \forall s \in S\ \forall b \in B\ (basecount(\ (s, b)\ ) = n)$$

In English:

Counterexample that proves this universal quantification is false:

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (17)

Alternating quantifiers strategies rna examples

Alternating nested quantifiers

$$\forall s \in S \; \exists b \in B \; (\; basecount(\; (s, b) \;) = 3 \;)$$

In English: For each RNA strand there is a base that occurs 3 times in this strand.

Write the negation and use De Morgan's law to find a logically equivalent version where the negation is applied only to the BC predicate (not next to a quantifier).

Is the original statement **True** or **False**?

$$\exists s \in S \; \forall b \in B \; \exists n \in \mathbb{N} \; (\; basecount(\; (s, b) \;) = n \;)$$

In English: There is an RNA strand so that for each base there is some nonnegative integer that counts the number of occurrences of that base in this strand.

Write the negation and use De Morgan's law to find a logically equivalent version where the negation is applied only to the BC predicate (not next to a quantifier).

Is the original statement **True** or **False**?

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (18)

Rna rnalen basecount definitions

Recall the definitions: The set of RNA strands S is defined (recursively) by:

Basis Step:	$\mathtt{A} \in S, \mathtt{C} \in S, \mathtt{U} \in S, \mathtt{G} \in S$
Recursive Step:	If $s \in S$ and $b \in B$, then $sb \in S$

where sb is string concatenation.

The function *rnalen* that computes the length of RNA strands in S is defined recursively by:

		$rnalen : S$	$\to \mathbb{Z}^+$
Basis Step:	If $b \in B$ then	$rnalen(b)$	$= 1$
Recursive Step:	If $s \in S$ and $b \in B$, then	$rnalen(sb)$	$= 1 + rnalen(s)$

The function *basecount* that computes the number of a given base b appearing in a RNA strand s is defined recursively by:

		$basecount : S \times B$	$\to \mathbb{N}$	
Basis Step:	If $b_1 \in B, b_2 \in B$	$basecount(\ (b_1, b_2)\ )$	$= \begin{cases} 1 & \text{when } b_1 = b_2 \\ 0 & \text{when } b_1 \neq b_2 \end{cases}$	
Recursive Step:	If $s \in S, b_1 \in B, b_2 \in B$	$basecount(\ (sb_1, b_2)\ )$	$= \begin{cases} 1 + basecount(\ (s, b_2)\ ) & \text{when } b_1 = b_2 \\ basecount(\ (s, b_2)\ ) & \text{when } b_1 \neq b_2 \end{cases}$	

Alternating quantifiers proofs rna examples

Which proof strategies could be used to prove each of the following statements?

Hint: first translate the statements to English and identify the main logical structure.

$\forall b \in B\ \exists s \in S\ (\ basecount(\ (s, b)\ )\ > 0\ )$

$\exists s \in S\ \forall b \in B\ (\ basecount(\ (s, b)\ )\ > 0\ )$

$\exists s \in S\, (rnalen(s) = basecount(\ (s, \mathtt{A})\ )$

$\forall s \in S\ \exists b \in B\ (\ basecount(\ (s, b)\ ) > 0\ )$

$\forall s \in S\, (rnalen(s) \geq basecount(\ (s, \mathtt{A})\ ))$

$\forall s \in S\ (\ rnalen(s) > 0\ )$

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (19)

Structural induction motivating example rna

Claim $\forall s \in S$ ($rnalen(s) > 0$)

Proof: Let s be an arbitrary RNA strand. By the recursive definition of S, either $s \in B$ or there is some strand s_0 and some base b such that $s = s_0 b$. We will show that the inequality holds for both cases.

Case: Assume $s \in B$. We need to show $rnalen(s) > 0$. By the basis step in the definition of $rnalen$,

$$rnalen(s) = 1$$

which is greater than 0, as required.

Case: Assume there is some strand s_0 and some base b such that $s = s_0 b$. We will show *(the stronger claim)* that

$$\forall u \in S \; \forall b \in B \; (\; rnalen(u) > 0 \rightarrow rnalen(ub) > 0 \;)$$

Consider an arbitrary RNA strand u and an arbitrary base b, and assume towards a direct proof, that

$$rnalen(u) > 0$$

We need to show that $rnalen(ub) > 0$.

$$rnalen(ub) = 1 + rnalen(u) > 1 + 0 = 1 > 0$$

as required.

Proof strategies structural induction

Proof by Structural Induction To prove a universal quantification over a recursively defined set:

Basis Step: Show the statement holds for elements specified in the basis step of the definition.

Recursive Step: Show that if the statement is true for each of the elements used to construct new elements in the recursive step of the definition, the result holds for these new elements.

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (20)

Structural induction example rnalen basecount

Claim $\forall s \in S\,(rnalen(s) \geq basecount(\ (s, \mathtt{A})\ ))$:

Proof: We proceed by structural induction on the recursively defined set S.

Basis Case: We need to prove that the inequality holds for each element in the basis step of the recursive definition of S. Need to show

$$(\ rnalen(\mathtt{A}) \geq basecount(\ (\mathtt{A}, \mathtt{A})\ )\ ) \wedge (\ rnalen(\mathtt{C}) \geq basecount(\ (\mathtt{C}, \mathtt{A})\ )\ )$$
$$\wedge(\ rnalen(\mathtt{U}) \geq basecount(\ (\mathtt{U}, \mathtt{A})\ )\ ) \wedge (\ rnalen(\mathtt{G}) \geq basecount(\ (\mathtt{G}, \mathtt{A})\ )\ )$$

We calculate, using the definitions of *rnalen* and *basecount*:

Recursive Case: We will prove that

$$\forall u \in S\ \forall b \in B\ (\ rnalen(u) \geq basecount(\ (u, \mathtt{A})\ ) \rightarrow rnalen(ub) \geq basecount(\ (ub, \mathtt{A})\ )$$

Consider arbitrary RNA strand u and arbitrary base b. Assume, as the **induction hypothesis**, that $rnalen(u) \geq basecount(\ (u, \mathtt{A})\ )$. We need to show that $rnalen(ub) \geq basecount(\ (ub, \mathtt{A})\ )$.

Using the recursive step in the definition of the function *rnalen*:

$$rnalen(ub) = 1 + rnalen(u)$$

The recursive step in the definition of the function *basecount* has two cases. We notice that $b = \mathtt{A} \vee b \neq \mathtt{A}$ and we proceed by cases.

Case i. Assume $b = \mathtt{A}$.

Using the first case in the recursive step in the definition of the function *basecount*:

$$basecount(\ (ub, \mathtt{A})\ ) = 1 + basecount(\ (u, \mathtt{A})\ )$$

By the **induction hypothesis**, we know that $basecount(\ (u, \mathtt{A})\ ) \leq rnalen(u)$ so:

$$basecount(\ (ub, \mathtt{A})\ ) = 1 + basecount(\ (u, \mathtt{A})\ ) \leq 1 + rnalen(u) = rnalen(ub)$$

and, thus, $basecount(\ (ub, \mathtt{A})\ ) \leq rnalen(ub)$, as required.

Case ii. Assume $b \neq \mathtt{A}$.

Using the second case in the recursive step in the definition of the function *basecount*:

$$basecount(\ (ub, \mathtt{A})\ ) = basecount(\ (u, \mathtt{A})\ )$$

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (21)

By the **induction hypothesis**, we know that $basecount(\ (u, \texttt{A})\ ) \leq rnalen(u)$ so:

$$basecount(\ (ub, \texttt{A})\ ) = basecount(\ (u, \texttt{A})\ ) \leq rnalen(u) < 1 + rnalen(u) = rnalen(ub)$$

and, thus, $basecount(\ (ub, \texttt{A})\ ) \leq rnalen(ub)$, as required.

Proofs signposting kinds of claims

To organize our proofs, it's useful to highlight which claims are most important for our overall goals. We use some terminology to describe different roles statements can have.

Theorem: Statement that can be shown to be true, usually an important one.

Less important theorems can be called **proposition**, **fact**, **result**, **claim**.

Lemma: A less important theorem that is useful in proving a theorem.

Corollary: A theorem that can be proved directly after another one has been proved, without needing a lot of extra work.

Invariant: A theorem that describes a property that is true about an algorithm or system no matter what inputs are used.

Proof strategy mathematical induction

Proof by Mathematical Induction
To prove a universal quantification over the set of all integers greater than or equal to some base integer b,

Basis Step: Show the property holds for b.

Recursive Step: Consider an arbitrary integer n greater than or equal to b, assume (as the **induction hypothesis**) that the property holds for n, and use this and other facts to prove that the property holds for $n + 1$.

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (22)

Structural induction example sum of powers

The set $\mathbb{N}$ is recursively defined. Therefore, the function $sumPow : \mathbb{N} \to \mathbb{N}$ which computes, for input i, the sum of the nonnegative powers of 2 up to and including exponent i is defined recursively by

Basis step: $sumPow(0) = 1$

Recursive step: If $x \in \mathbb{N}$, then $sumPow(x+1) = sumPow(x) + 2^{x+1}$

$sumPow(0) =$

$sumPow(1) =$

$sumPow(2) =$

Fill in the blanks in the following proof of

$$\forall n \in \mathbb{N}\ (sumPow(n) = 2^{n+1} - 1)$$

Proof: Since $\mathbb{N}$ is recursively defined, we proceed by _____.

Basis case: We need to show that _____. Evaluating each side: $LHS = sumPow(0) = 1$ by the basis case in the recursive definition of $sumPow$; $RHS = 2^{0+1} - 1 = 2^1 - 1 = 2 - 1 = 1$. Since $1 = 1$, the equality holds.

Recursive case: Consider arbitrary natural number n and assume, as the _____ that $sumPow(n) = 2^{n+1} - 1$. We need to show that _____. Evaluating each side:

$$LHS = sumPow(n+1) \overset{\text{rec def}}{=} sumPow(n) + 2^{n+1} \overset{\text{IH}}{=} (2^{n+1} - 1) + 2^{n+1}.$$

$$RHS = 2^{(n+1)+1} - 1 \overset{\text{exponent rules}}{=} 2 \cdot 2^{n+1} - 1 = \left(2^{n+1} + 2^{n+1}\right) - 1 \overset{\text{regrouping}}{=} (2^{n+1} - 1) + 2^{n+1}$$

Thus, $LHS = RHS$. The structural induction is complete and we have proved the universal generalization. □

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (23)

Proof strategy strong induction

Proof by Strong Induction
To prove that a universal quantification over the set of all integers greater than or equal to some base integer b holds, pick a fixed nonnegative integer j and then:

Basis Step:	Show the statement holds for b, $b+1$, $\ldots$, $b+j$.
Recursive Step:	Consider an arbitrary integer n greater than or equal to $b+j$, assume (as the **strong induction hypothesis**) that the property holds for **each of** b, $b+1$, $\ldots$, n, and use this and other facts to prove that the property holds for $n+1$.

Binary expansions exist proof

Theorem: Every positive integer is a sum of (one or more) distinct powers of 2. *Binary expansions exist!*

The idea in the "Least significant first" algorithm for computing binary expansions is that the binary expansion of *half* a number becomes *part* of the binary expansion of the number of itself. We can use this idea in a proof by strong induction that binary expansions exist for all positive integers n.

Proof by strong induction, with $b = 1$ and $j = 0$. We need to prove that for each positive integer n, there is a positive integer k and coefficients $a_0, \ldots, a_{k-1}$ where each a_i is 0 or 1 and $a_{k-1} \neq 0$, and

$$n = \sum_{i=0}^{k-1} a_i 2^i$$

Basis step: WTS property is true about 1.

Recursive step: Consider an arbitrary integer $n \geq 1$.

Assume (as the strong induction hypothesis, IH) that the property is true about each of $1, \ldots, n$.

WTS that the property is true about $n+1$.

Idea: We will apply the IH to $(n+1)$ **div** 2.

Why is this ok?

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (24)

Why is this helpful?

By the IH, we can write $(n+1)$ **div** 2 as a sum of powers of 2. In other words, there are values $a_{k-1}, \ldots, a_0$ such that each a_i is 0 or 1, $a_{k-1} = 1$, and

$$\sum_{i=0}^{k-1} a_i 2^i = (n+1) \textbf{ div } 2$$

Define the collection of coefficients

$$c_j = \begin{cases} a_{j-1} & \text{if } 1 \le j \le k \\ (n+1) \textbf{ mod } 2 & \text{if } j = 0 \end{cases}$$

Calculating:

$$\begin{aligned}
\sum_{j=0}^{k} c_j 2^j &= c_0 + \sum_{j=1}^{k} c_j 2^j = c_0 + \sum_{i=0}^{k-1} c_{i+1} 2^{i+1} && \text{re-indexing the summation} \\
&= c_0 + 2 \cdot \sum_{i=0}^{k-1} c_{i+1} 2^i && \text{factoring out a 2 from each term in the sum} \\
&= c_0 + 2 \cdot \sum_{i=0}^{k-1} a_i 2^i && \text{by definition of } c_{i+1} \\
&= c_0 + 2\,(\ (n+1) \textbf{ div } 2\ ) && \text{by IH} \\
&= (\ (n+1) \textbf{ mod } 2\ ) + 2\,(\ (n+1) \textbf{ div } 2\ ) && \text{by definition of } c_0 \\
&= n+1 && \text{by definition of long division}
\end{aligned}$$

Thus, $n+1$ can be expressed as a sum of powers of 2, as required.

Linked lists definition

Definition The set of linked lists of natural numbers L is defined recursively by

Basis Step:	$[] \in L$
Recursive Step:	If $l \in L$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$, then $(n, l) \in L$

Linked lists examples

Visually:

Example: the list with two nodes whose first node has 20 and whose second node has 42

Linked list length definition

Definition: The length of a linked list of natural numbers L, $length : L \to \mathbb{N}$ is defined by

Basis Step:		$length(\ []\ )$	$= 0$
Recursive Step:	If $l \in L$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$, then	$length(\ (n, l)\ )$	$= 1 + length(l)$

Linked lists prepend definition

Definition: The function $prepend : L \times \mathbb{N} \to L$ that adds an element at the front of a linked list is defined by

Linked list append definition

Definition The function $append : L \times \mathbb{N} \to L$ that adds an element at the end of a linked list is defined by

Basis Step:	If $m \in \mathbb{N}$ then
Recursive Step:	If $l \in L$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $m \in \mathbb{N}$, then

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (26)

Linked list append length claim proof

Claim: $\forall l \in L$ ($length($ $append($ $(l, 100)$)) $> length(l)$)

Proof: By structural induction on L, we have two cases:

Basis Step

1. **To Show** $length($ $append($ $([], 100)$)) $> length($ [])	Because [] is the only element defined in the basis step of L, we only need to prove that the property holds for [].
2. **To Show** $length($ $(100, [])$) $> length($ [])	By basis step in definition of *append*.
3. **To Show** $(1 + length($ [])) $> length($ [])	By recursive step in definition of *length*.
4. **To Show** $1 + 0 > 0$	By basis step in definition of *length*.
5. T	By properties of integers
QED	Because we got to T only by rewriting **To Show** to equivalent statements, using well-defined proof techniques, and applying definitions.

Recursive Step

Consider an arbitrary: $l' \in L$, $n \in \mathbb{N}$, and we assume as the **induction hypothesis** that:

$$length(\ append(\ (l', 100\ )\ )\ ) > length(l')$$

Our goal is to show that $length($ $append($ $(\ (n, l'), 100\ )\ )\ ) > length($ (n, l')) is also true. We start by working with one side of the candidate inequality:

$$\begin{aligned}
LHS &= length(\ append(\ (\ (n, l'), 100\ )\ )\ ) \\
&= length(\ (n, append(\ (l', 100)\ )\ )\ ) \qquad \text{by the recursive definition of } append \\
&= 1 + length(\ append(\ (l', 100)\ )\ ) \qquad \text{by the recursive definition of } length \\
&> 1 + length(l') \qquad \text{by the induction hypothesis} \\
&= length((n, l')) \qquad \text{by the recursive definition of } length \\
&= RHS
\end{aligned}$$

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (27)

Linked list example each length

Prove or disprove: $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}\ \exists l \in L\ (\ length(l) = n\ )$

Tautology contradiction contingency examples

Label each of the following as a tautology, contradiction, or contingency.

$p \wedge p$

$p \oplus p$

$p \vee p$

$p \vee \neg p$

$p \wedge \neg p$

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (28)

Why represent numbers

Modeling uses data-types that are encoded in a computer. The details of the encoding impact the efficiency of algorithms we use to understand the systems we are modeling and the impacts of these algorithms on the people using the systems. Case study: how to encode numbers?

Fixed width example

Decimal $b = 10$	Binary $b = 2$	Binary fixed-width 10 $b = 2$, $w = 10$	Binary fixed-width 7 $b = 2$, $w = 7$	Binary fixed-width 4 $b = 2$, $w = 4$
$(20)_{10}$				

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (29)

Fixed width fractional

Definition For b an integer greater than 1, w a positive integer, w' a positive integer, and x a real number the **base b fixed-width expansion of x with integer part width w and fractional part width w'** is $(a_{w-1} \cdots a_1 a_0 . c_1 \cdots c_{w'})_{b,w,w'}$ where $a_0, a_1, \ldots, a_{w-1}, c_1, \ldots, c_{w'}$ are nonnegative integers less than b and

$$x \geq \sum_{i=0}^{w-1} a_i b^i + \sum_{j=1}^{w'} c_j b^{-j} \qquad \text{and} \qquad x < \sum_{i=0}^{w-1} a_i b^i + \sum_{j=1}^{w'} c_j b^{-j} + b^{-w'}$$

3.75 in fixed-width binary, integer part width 2, fractional part width 8	
0.1 in fixed-width binary, integer part width 2, fractional part width 8	

```
|welcome $jshell
|  Welcome to JShell -- Version 10.0.1
|  For an introduction type: /help intro

jshell> 0.1
$1 ==>

jshell> 0.2
$2 ==>

jshell> 0.1 + 0.2
$3 ==>

jshell> Math.sqrt(2)
$4 ==>

jshell> Math.sqrt(2)*Math.sqrt(2)
$5 ==>

jshell>
```

Note: Java uses floating point, not fixed width representation, but similar rounding errors appear in both.

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (30)

Negative int expansions

Representing negative integers in binary: Fix a positive integer width for the representation w, $w > 1$.

	To represent a positive integer n	To represent a negative integer $-n$
Sign-magnitude	$[0a_{w-2} \cdots a_0]_{s,w}$, where $n = (a_{w-2} \cdots a_0)_{2,w-1}$ Example $n = 17$, $w = 7$:	$[1a_{w-2} \cdots a_0]_{s,w}$, where $n = (a_{w-2} \cdots a_0)_{2,w-1}$ Example $-n = -17$, $w = 7$:
2s complement	$[0a_{w-2} \cdots a_0]_{2c,w}$, where $n = (a_{w-2} \cdots a_0)_{2,w-1}$ Example $n = 17$, $w = 7$:	$[1a_{w-2} \cdots a_0]_{2c,w}$, where $2^{w-1} - n = (a_{w-2} \cdots a_0)_{2,w-1}$ Example $-n = -17$, $w = 7$:

Calculating 2s complement

For positive integer n, to represent $-n$ in 2s complement with width w,

- Calculate $2^{w-1} - n$, convert result to binary fixed-width $w - 1$, pad with leading 1, or
- Express $-n$ as a sum of powers of 2, where the leftmost 2^{w-1} is negative weight, or
- Convert n to binary fixed-width w, flip bits, add 1 (ignore overflow)

Challenge: use definitions to explain why each of these approaches works.

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version November 3, 2026 (31)